

Using the Windows Registry

The registry is made up of registry values (instructions) that are contained within registry keys (folders that store more data), all of which are contained within one of multiple registry hives (folders that categorise all the data in the registry using subfolders). Using Registry Editor to alter these values and keys affects the configuration that each value controls. We'll go through all of the best ways to alter the Windows Registry in the next chapters.

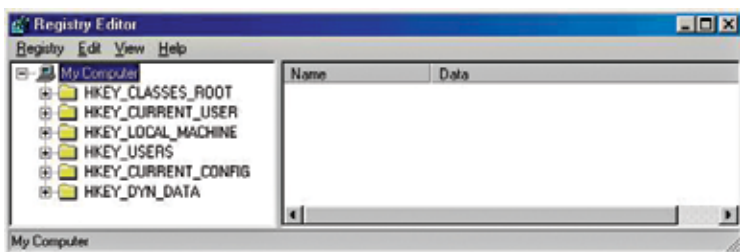
Changing registry settings solves a problem, answers a question, or affects the behaviour of a programme. Windows and other programmes frequently refer to the registry. Changes to practically any configuration are reflected in the proper parts of the registry, however, these changes may not be apparent until the computer is restarted.

Because the Windows Registry is so crucial, backing up the bits you're modifying before you update them is critical. .REG files are used to save backups of the Windows Registry.

This also means that you can restore the registry. Backing up the registry is a common practice before making a significant change to the operating system. Especially for folks who are employed as IT Admins in companies.

In every Windows since `95

Nearly every Microsoft Windows version, including Windows 11, Windows 10, Windows 8, Windows 7, Windows Vista, Windows XP, Windows 2000, Windows NT, Windows 98, and Windows 95, includes the Windows Registry and the Microsoft Registry Editor software.



Windows 95 Registry Editor

Despite the fact that the registry is present in practically every Windows edition, there are some minor changes. In MS-DOS and early versions of Windows, there were several other files such as autoexec.bat, config.sys,